

such as MissingMoney.com and Unclaimed.org, which are both maintained by the National Association of Unclaimed Property Administrators (NAUPA), can help you in your search by listing contact info for each state office and providing a search tool for several treasuries at one time.

WHAT TO DO?

Once you have found what might be unclaimed property that should be in your possession, there will be a form and some simple verification steps to follow to prove to the state that you are the rightful owner. Once this has been established, you can arrange for your property to be returned to you.

(Note: Please don't ever pay anyone to "find" property for you. This is a service that your state treasury will gladly provide you for free. It is their job, and since most unclaimed property has a value of less than \$100, it does you no good to pay someone to do what you and your state treasury can accomplish on your own.)

NO PROPERTY?

Even if you don't have any property, you can still take advantage of the billions of dollars of unclaimed items left

abandoned in the possession of state treasuries. Many of them are now selling this property on eBay and other online auction sites. To see a quick view of some of the items that the state of Maryland has up for auction, for example, view their seller's item list at Ebay.com/usr/mdcompfranchot. It just may be a great way to get a good buy on that 1978 Krugerrand you've always wanted!

Unclaimed property is the coolest lost-and-found out there. Check it out today, and see if you don't have a little unknown treasure waiting for you!

— Linsey Knerl

8 Truths from a Mystery Shopper

Mystery shopping is a respectable gig for someone with some time, ambition, and a desire to do something different. As a mystery shopper, you'll visit retail stores as a casual shopper, and gather information about displays, prices, customer service and so on. You're hired and report back to a market research firm or a manufacturer. Having mystery-